



IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Drama

DIRECTOR

Krzysztof Kieslowski

WRITERS

**Krzysztof Kieslowski,
Krzysztof Piesiewicz**

STARS

**Irène Jacob, Jean-Louis
Trintignant**

BEFORE

1987 In *Blind Chance*, Kieslowski explores the influence of chance and choice in three alternate stories about a man catching a train.

1991 Kieslowski teams up with Irène Jacob for the first time with *The Double Life of Veronique*.

AFTER

2002 Kieslowski's last screenplay, *Heaven*, is directed by Tom Tykwer and stars Cate Blanchett. It had been written as the first in a new trilogy.

I FEEL SOMETHING IMPORTANT IS HAPPENING AROUND ME. AND IT SCARES ME

THREE COLORS: RED / 1994

Three Colors: Red is the final part of Krzysztof Kieslowski's trilogy based on the three colors of the French flag: red, white, and blue. Each movie explores one of the three ideals of the French Revolution: liberty in *Blue* (1993), equality in *White* (1994), and, in *Red*, fraternity. *Red* is the warmest, most sympathetic of the three movies, featuring an affecting performance by Irène Jacob as Valentine.

Set in Geneva, Switzerland, the movie, shot through with symbolic red, tells what at first seem to be stories of separate lives, until deeper connections emerge. The central story is of a young model, Valentine, who accidentally runs over a dog with her car. She takes the dog to its owner, a reclusive

former judge, Joseph Kern (Jean-Louis Trintignant). Valentine and Kern form a strange rapport, such that, had they not missed each other by a mere 40 years, they may have fallen in love.

Reclusive observer

Kern has resigned from his career. Tired of passing judgement, he now simply wants to be an observer. He watches life

Valentine (Irène Jacob) discovers that the dog she injured is pregnant. Kern gives the dog to her when she returns it to him.

